

narrow down the list of functions you'll have to scroll through.

Clicking on any function in the “Select a function:” box will show you a brief description of what the function does in the space below the “Select a function” window. If you want to learn more about a particular function you can click the Help on this function link to open its help documentation.

Once you have made your selection, click OK to open the Function Arguments window. In this window, you enter specific values for the selected function. The available fields and values may vary; however, you will get a description of what is expected in each field. Some values may be required, others may be optional. At the minimum, you will have to enter the required values for the function to work and display a result without bringing up an error. Once you've entered the values you require to, click OK to display the result in your worksheet.

A function consists of some standard parts. In general, a function is of the form:

**=function\_name(argument1, argument2, ...argumentN)**

All Excel functions—which are actually advanced formulas—start with the equals sign followed by the name of the function. This is followed by the open bracket, then followed by a number of arguments that may

use any of the valid operators—arithmetic, comparison, text, or reference (as discussed above). Last comes the closing bracket.

An argument is a value that can be assigned by either specify-



Entering the values for your function